



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Learning something new is fun!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What things did you learn to do with an older relative when you were a child?
- How important is it for older people to pass on their knowledge to younger people?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can talk about what happened and what had happened.
- I can explain the sequence of events.





Let's Explore!

His father was **gone***

* When we say someone is "gone", they can just be away, or they may have died.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I fully realized that father was gone forever when I walked into his workshop. I think I had expected to walk in the door and find him hunched over his workbench. I had expected him to turn around and give me a knife so I could join him while he whittled away, making some small wooden animal or toy. As I stood there looking at the empty workbench, I remembered the time I had spent with him in that room. My mother had died when I was eight years old. My father, seemingly anxious and hardworking man, only felt calm and relaxed when he was carving a piece of wood. This he did whenever he could.

As I got older, spending time with Dad in his workshop seemed boring. After I had started going to high school, my extra time had been taken up with other things. When I saw Dad in the workshop, I stopped and said hello, but rarely sat with him. Of course, when I went away to university we grew even further apart. I went home now and then for a holiday when I could, but that wasn't often.

By the time I had started working, our weekly talk had become monthly. The visits became infrequent. However, after I had become a parent myself our visits became more regular. I sat with my dad while we both whittled away at the wood. I talked about my life, often with my own son on my knee. I discovered he was a sensitive, caring person with a deep insight into life and human nature. Over toy cars and little boats, I gained new respect for the man sitting next to me. All these memories had come flooding back to me as I stood staring at the empty workshop.





Let's Practice!

He's thinking about his father.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. I think I had expected to walk
2. I had expected him to
3. As I stood there looking at
4. My mother had died when I
5. All these memories had come flooding
6. By the time I had started working,
7. However, after I had become a parent myself
8. After I had started

COLUMN B

- a. back to me as I stood staring at the empty workshop.
- b. turn around and give me a knife so I could join him while he whittled away, making some small wooden animal or toy.
- c. our visits became more regular.
- d. our weekly talks had become monthly ones.
- e. was eight years old.
- f. in the door and find him hunched over his workbench.
- g. going to high school, my extra time had been taken up with other things.
- h. the empty workbench, I remembered the time I had spent with him in that room.



Let's Practice!

He talks about the great memories he had with his father.

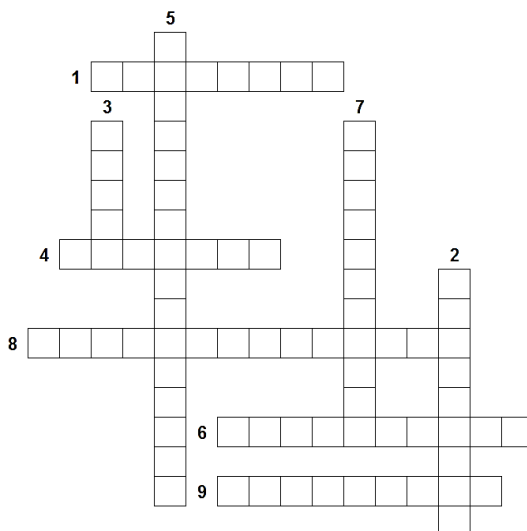
Instructions: Read the definitions. Complete the crossword writing the words that are being defined. First, read the clue. Then, write your answer.

Down

2. A bench at which carpentry or other mechanical or practical work is done
3. To bend your back and shoulders into a rounded shape
5. To gradually lose a connection to someone (3 words)
7. Behaviors and feelings common to most people (2 words)

Across

1. A room or building in which goods are manufactured or repaired
4. To slice thin pieces from a piece of wood
6. Not happening often; rare
8. To feel admiration for someone who you previously did not admire (3 words)
9. To return suddenly (2 words)





Extension Activity

Talk about something you did when you were a child.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about something you did with an older family member or friend when you were a child.
- Make a timeline and say what happened and what had happened in sequence.
- Add adjectives to the timeline to expand the story and talk about relationships and people.
- Put your story in point form on a card or paper.
- Use your outline to explain what you did with an older family member or friend to a partner or group.



Target Words

- workshop** (noun): a room or building in which goods are manufactured or repaired
e.g. I fully realized that father was gone forever when I walked into his workshop.
- workbench** (noun): a bench at which carpentry or other mechanical or practical work is done
e.g. As I stood there looking at the empty workbench, I remembered.
- to hunch** (verb): to bend your back and shoulders into a rounded shape
e.g. I think I had expected to walk in the door and find him hunched over his workbench.
- to whittle** (verb): to slice thin pieces from a piece of wood
e.g. I sat with my dad while we both whittled away at the wood.
- to grow farther apart** (expression): to gradually lose a connection to someone
e.g. Of course, when I went away to university, we grew even farther apart.
- infrequent** (adjective): not happening often; rare
e.g. The visits became infrequent.
- human nature** (noun): behaviors and feelings common to most people
e.g. I discovered he was a sensitive, caring person with a deep insight into life and human nature.
- to gain respect for** (expression): to feel admiration for someone who you previously did not admire
e.g. Over toy cars and little boats, I gained new respect for the man sitting next to me.
- to flood back** (verb): to return suddenly
e.g. All these memories had come flooding back to me as I stood staring at the empty workshop.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write about something I did with an older family member or friend when I was a child.

☐ ☐

I make a timeline and add adjectives to talk about relationships and personalities.

☐ ☐

I use the Simple Past and the Past Perfect tenses.

☐ ☐

I share the activity I did with an older family member or friend when I was a child with a partner.

☐ ☐



Learning Points

The Past Perfect and the Simple Past Tenses

In a narrative (spoken or written) when you want to refer to different past events, you can use either the Simple Past or the Past Perfect.

You use the Past Perfect to be precise about which event happened before another event. This is especially useful when you have many past actions being described in a non-sequential order.

Once you have introduced the scenario to your readers or listeners, and they understand that you are talking about events before another past event, you can use the Simple Past to continue the story. You don't have to continue using the Past Perfect.

For example:

We **bought** a new computer last month. Up until then, we **had used** my sister's but it **started** (**had started**) to act up and she **needed** (**had needed**) it back anyway. We **took** (**had taken**) it to the repair shop but that **didn't solve** (**hadn't solved**) the issues we were having.

If you use time markers to make the order of events clear, you can use either the Simple Past or the Past Perfect.

For example:

After Harold **finished** his work ... (or **After** Harold **had finished** his work ...)

Examples:

- I think I **had expected** to walk in the door and find him hunched over his workbench.
- I **had expected** him to turn around and give me a knife so I could join him while he whittled away, making some small wooden animal or toy.
- As I stood there looking at the empty workbench, I remembered the time I **had spent** with him in that room.
- My mother **had died** when I was eight years old.
- All these memories **had come flooding back** to me as I stood staring at the empty workshop.
- By the time I **had started** working, our weekly talks **had become** monthly ones.
- However, after I **had become** a parent myself our visits **became** more regular.
- After I **had started** going to high school, my extra time **had been taken up** with other things.

